

Code of Conduct

Document: COC-001 **Version:** 4.0 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Human Resources & Legal

1. Purpose

This Code of Conduct sets out the ethical and professional standards expected of all Northwind Logistics employees, contractors, and authorized representatives. Compliance is a condition of employment.

2. Honesty and integrity

2.1. Employees are expected to be honest in all dealings with colleagues, clients, vendors, regulators, and the public.

2.2. Misrepresentation of facts, falsification of records (including expense reports, time sheets, or invoices), or concealment of material information is grounds for immediate termination.

3. Respect in the workplace

3.1. Northwind is committed to a workplace free from harassment, discrimination, and bullying. Employees are expected to treat colleagues with respect regardless of race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, religion, age, disability, or any other protected characteristic.

3.2. Concerns or complaints should be raised with the employee's manager, HR, or via the anonymous ethics hotline.

4. Conflicts of interest

4.1. Employees must disclose, in writing to their manager, any actual or potential conflict of interest. Examples include:

- Personal or family relationships with vendors, clients, or job candidates
- Outside business interests that compete with the Company
- Investments in Company clients or vendors above 1% ownership

4.2. Decisions made on behalf of the Company must be made in the Company's interest. Where a conflict exists, the employee must recuse themselves from the relevant decision.

5. Confidentiality

5.1. Employees have access to confidential information about the Company, its clients, its strategies, and its employees. This information must not be disclosed outside the Company except as required by the employee's role.

5.2. Confidentiality obligations survive the end of employment.

6. Use of company resources

6.1. Company resources (funds, equipment, time, intellectual property) are to be used for business purposes. Limited and occasional personal use of equipment (e.g., personal email at lunch) is acceptable; sustained personal use is not.

6.2. Expense reports submitted under the Travel & Expense Policy framework (TEP-001 et seq.) must accurately reflect business expenses actually incurred. Inflated, fabricated, or duplicated expense claims are treated as falsification of records under Section 2.

7. Gifts and entertainment

See the Gifts and Entertainment Policy (TEP-012) for specific rules. The principles in this section apply:

7.1. Gifts and entertainment should never influence, or appear to influence, business decisions.

7.2. Employees should refuse gifts whose acceptance would create the appearance of impropriety, regardless of monetary value.

8. Compliance with law

Employees must comply with all applicable laws and regulations in jurisdictions where the Company operates, including but not limited to anti-bribery, anti-money-laundering, antitrust, employment, tax, and securities laws.

9. Reporting violations

9.1. Employees who become aware of a potential violation of this Code are expected to report it through one of the following channels:

- Direct manager
- Skip-level manager
- Human Resources
- General Counsel
- Anonymous Ethics Hotline (operated by a third party)

9.2. The Company prohibits retaliation against any employee who reports a concern in good faith, even if the concern proves unfounded after investigation.

10. Enforcement

Violations of this Code are subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination. Certain violations may also be reported to law enforcement or regulatory authorities.

11. Definitions

- **Conflict of interest** — A situation in which an employee's personal interests, relationships, or outside activities could compromise — or appear to compromise — their judgment, objectivity, or loyalty to the Company.
- **Confidential information** — Non-public information about the Company, its clients, employees, vendors, or strategy, the disclosure of which could harm the Company or any of its stakeholders.
- **Material violation** — A violation of this Code that has, or could have, a significant effect on the Company, its operations, its reputation, or compliance with law.
- **Good faith** — Acting on a reasonable belief in the truth or significance of one's statements or actions.

12. Related documents

- TEP-001 Travel & Expense Policy — Overview (financial conduct)
- TEP-012 Gifts and Entertainment Policy
- HR-104 Workplace Inclusion and Anti-Discrimination Policy
- LEG-101 Whistleblower and Ethics Reporting Policy
- LEG-203 Intellectual Property and Proprietary Information Policy
- SEC-201 Data Classification (confidentiality controls)
- SEC-202 Acceptable Use of IT Resources
- PROC-002 Vendor Onboarding (anti-bribery context)

13. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2018-01-01	M. Quincy	Initial publication
2.0	2020-04-15	M. Quincy	Post-IPO restructure; expanded compliance section
3.0	2022-09-30	M. Quincy	Aligned with new reporting channels
4.0	2025-01-01	M. Quincy	Restructure; annual review

Next scheduled review: 2026-01-01 **Document owner:** General Counsel

legal@northwindlogistics.com **Approver:** General Counsel; reviewed annually by the Audit Committee

Distribution: All employees; annual attestation required. Available on intranet at
intranet.northwindlogistics.com/policies/coc-001

Remote Work Stipend Policy

Document: HRP-015 **Version:** 1.1 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Human Resources

1. Scope

This policy governs Company support for remote and hybrid work arrangements, including one-time home office setup and ongoing monthly stipends. It does not govern travel and is not part of the Travel & Expense Policy framework.

2. Eligibility

2.1. Employees in roles formally designated as **Remote** or **Hybrid** are eligible for this stipend. Roles designated as **In-Office** are not eligible.

2.2. The role designation is recorded in the employee's HR record and may be changed only with the agreement of the employee's manager and HR.

3. One-time home office setup

3.1. New remote and hybrid employees are eligible for a one-time home office setup allowance of **\$1,500 (USD)**, to be used within the first 90 days of employment in the eligible role.

3.2. The allowance may be used for:

- Desk
- Office chair
- Monitor (single, up to 32 inches)
- Keyboard and mouse
- Webcam and microphone
- Desk lamp
- Cable management and small accessories

3.3. The following are not eligible under the one-time allowance:

- Computers, tablets, and phones (provided separately by IT)
- Office furniture beyond the desk-and-chair pairing (e.g., bookshelves, filing cabinets)
- Decor, plants, or aesthetic items
- Software and subscriptions

3.4. Receipts are required for all purchases under this allowance, per the standard receipt requirements (TEP-007).

4. Monthly stipend

4.1. Eligible employees receive a monthly remote-work stipend of **\$80**, intended to offset internet, electricity, and basic supplies costs associated with working from home.

4.2. The monthly stipend is paid through payroll, is not a reimbursement, and does not require receipts.

4.3. The stipend is treated as taxable income to the employee, consistent with applicable tax rules.

5. Return and recapture

5.1. Items purchased under the one-time setup allowance remain the employee's property and do not need to be returned at end of employment, provided the employee has been in the eligible role for at least 12 months.

5.2. Employees who separate from the Company within 12 months of receiving the setup allowance are subject to pro-rata recapture of the allowance through final-payroll deduction.

6. Coordination with travel policy

6.1. The Remote Work Stipend is distinct from travel reimbursements. Travel between the employee's home and a Company office is generally considered commuting (not reimbursable per TEP-006 §4.2), unless the employee is designated Remote and the office visit is at the Company's specific request.

6.2. When a Remote employee is asked by the Company to travel to a Company office for a meeting, training, or event, the trip is treated as business travel and is reimbursed under the standard framework.

7. Definitions

- **Remote** — A role designation where the employee primarily works from a non-Company location and is not expected to be in an office regularly.
- **Hybrid** — A role designation where the employee splits time between a Company office and a non-Company location, typically with a minimum in-office cadence set by the manager.
- **In-Office** — A role designation where the employee is expected to be at a Company office during normal working hours.
- **Setup allowance** — The one-time allowance for home office equipment described in §3.

8. Related documents

- HR-104 Workplace Inclusion and Anti-Discrimination Policy
- HR-208 Employee Referral Program (separate; HR-managed)
- TEP-006 Ground Transportation Policy (commuting vs. business travel)

- SEC-204 Mobile Device Acceptable Use Standard (BYOD)
- SEC-202 IT Acceptable Use Policy

9. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2022-08-15	L. Ahmed	Initial publication post-pandemic
1.1	2025-01-01	L. Ahmed	Annual review

Next scheduled review: 2026-01-01 **Document owner:** Human Resources

hr@northwindlogistics.com **Approver:** Chief People Officer **Distribution:** Remote and Hybrid employees; available on intranet at intranet.northwindlogistics.com/policies/hrp-015

Workplace Inclusion and Anti-Discrimination Policy

Document: HR-104 **Version:** 3.0 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Human Resources **Applies To:** All Northwind Logistics employees, contractors, applicants, vendors, and guests

1. Purpose

Northwind Logistics is committed to maintaining a workplace where every employee is treated with dignity and respect, has equal access to opportunity, and can contribute their best work without facing discrimination, harassment, or retaliation. This policy describes the standards of conduct expected of every person on Company premises and the procedures available to those who experience or witness violations.

2. Scope

This policy applies in every Company workplace — corporate offices, distribution centers, customer sites, Company vehicles, and Company-sponsored events. It applies to in-person and remote interactions, including communications via email, chat, video conference, and social media.

3. Equal opportunity

3.1. The Company prohibits discrimination against employees and applicants on the basis of race, color, ethnicity, national origin, ancestry, religion, sex, gender, gender identity, gender expression, sexual orientation, marital status, pregnancy, age, disability, genetic information, military or veteran status, or any other classification protected by applicable law.

3.2. Hiring, compensation, promotion, training, discipline, and termination decisions are made on the basis of legitimate, job-related factors.

3.3. The Company complies with all applicable laws regarding equal opportunity, including in the United States: Title VII of the Civil Rights Act, the Americans with Disabilities Act, the Age Discrimination in Employment Act, the Equal Pay Act, the Pregnancy Discrimination Act, and state and local equivalents.

4. Harassment

4.1. Harassment is unwelcome conduct based on a protected characteristic that creates a hostile, intimidating, or offensive work environment, or that affects employment decisions.

4.2. Examples include but are not limited to: slurs or jokes targeting a protected characteristic, displaying offensive material, unwanted physical contact, sexual advances, propositions, or pressure for personal interactions.

4.3. Sexual harassment is a specific form of harassment and is prohibited regardless of the genders or relationship of the parties involved.

5. Bullying and uncivil conduct

5.1. Even where conduct does not rise to the level of unlawful harassment, the Company expects civility. Bullying — repeated unreasonable conduct directed at an employee that intimidates, humiliates, or undermines — is prohibited.

5.2. Disagreement, criticism, and performance feedback delivered respectfully are not bullying.

6. Accommodation

6.1. The Company provides reasonable accommodation to employees and applicants with disabilities, sincerely held religious beliefs, pregnancy-related conditions, or other qualifying needs.

6.2. Accommodation requests should be directed to HR or through the Workday accommodation portal.

7. Reporting

7.1. Employees who experience or witness conduct violating this policy are encouraged to report it through any of: direct manager, skip-level manager, Human Resources, the General Counsel, or the anonymous Ethics Hotline (operated by an independent third party).

7.2. Reports may be made anonymously. The Company treats reports confidentially to the extent practical given the need to investigate.

8. Investigation

8.1. Reports are investigated promptly, typically within 30 days, by HR or a designated investigator independent of the alleged conduct.

8.2. Investigators may interview involved parties, review relevant documents, and consult subject-matter experts.

8.3. The Company communicates investigation outcomes to the reporter and the subject of the report to the extent permitted by privacy considerations and applicable law.

9. Non-retaliation

9.1. The Company prohibits retaliation against any employee who, in good faith, reports a concern, participates in an investigation, or refuses to participate in conduct that violates this policy.

9.2. Retaliation includes adverse employment action, exclusion, and informal mistreatment.

9.3. Retaliation is itself a violation of this policy and may result in disciplinary action up to termination.

10. Discipline

Violations of this policy result in disciplinary action proportionate to the severity, including written warning, performance plan, demotion, or termination. The Company also reserves the right to pursue civil or criminal remedies where warranted.

11. Training

11.1. All employees complete inclusion and anti-harassment training within 30 days of hire and annually thereafter.

11.2. People managers complete additional manager-specific training covering reporting obligations, accommodation processes, and difficult conversations.

12. Definitions

- **Protected characteristic** — A characteristic identified in Section 3.1 or under applicable law.
- **Adverse employment action** — A material change in the terms or conditions of employment, including termination, demotion, denial of promotion, significant reduction in responsibilities, or material change in compensation.
- **Good faith** — Acting on a reasonable belief in the truth of one's statements, regardless of whether the statements ultimately prove correct.

13. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2020-06-01	K. Adebayo	Initial publication
2.0	2022-11-08	K. Adebayo	Added accommodation procedure detail
2.5	2024-03-15	M. Patel	Updated training cadence; added remote workplace clarification
3.0	2025-01-01	M. Patel	Annual review and restructure

Next scheduled review: 2026-01-01 **Document owner:** Human Resources

hr@northwindlogistics.com **Approver:** General Counsel and Chief People Officer **Related**

documents: COC-001 Code of Conduct, HR-101 Open Door Policy, HR-115 Reasonable Accommodation Procedure

Employee Referral Program

Document: HR-208 **Version:** 1.3 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Talent Acquisition **Applies To:** All Northwind Logistics employees in eligible roles

1. Purpose

The Employee Referral Program (ERP) recognizes that employees are often best positioned to identify strong candidates for open Company roles. This document describes the program structure, referral process, bonuses, and the conditions under which bonuses are paid.

2. Eligibility

2.1 Referrer eligibility

2.1.1. All full-time and part-time employees of Northwind Logistics in active status are eligible to refer candidates, with the following exceptions:

- Members of the Talent Acquisition team
- Hiring managers for the specific role being filled
- The candidate's potential direct manager
- Members of the executive team (Grade 9+) — eligible to refer but not to receive a bonus

2.1.2. Contractors and temporary employees are not eligible to participate.

2.2 Candidate eligibility

2.2.1. To qualify for a referral bonus, the candidate must:

- Not have applied to the same role independently in the prior 90 days
- Not be currently employed by Northwind Logistics or its affiliates
- Not have been employed by Northwind Logistics or its affiliates within the prior 12 months (rehires are managed separately)
- Be referred via the ERP portal (referrals via personal email or LinkedIn DM without portal submission do not qualify)

3. Referral process

3.1. Submit a referral via the ERP portal at careers.northwindlogistics.com/referral, including the candidate's name, email, the role of interest, and (optionally) the referrer's notes about candidate fit.

3.2. The candidate receives an invitation email to apply through the standard application flow, with the referral attribution captured automatically.

3.3. Once the candidate applies, the standard recruiting process proceeds. The referrer may be asked for additional context but does not participate in interviews or decisions.

4. Referral bonuses

4.1 Bonus amounts by role

Role band	Bonus (USD, gross)
Individual contributor — Grades 1–4	\$2,500
Individual contributor — Grades 5–6	\$4,000
Manager / Senior IC — Grades 5–7	\$5,000
Director — Grade 7+	\$7,500
Vice President — Grade 9+	\$12,500
Strategic / hard-to-fill roles (designated by recruiting)	Up to \$15,000

4.2 Bonus payment

4.2.1. Bonuses are paid in two installments:

- 50% on the candidate's start date
- 50% after the candidate has been employed for 90 calendar days in good standing

4.2.2. Bonuses are paid through payroll and are subject to applicable taxes.

4.3 Multiple referrers

If multiple employees independently refer the same candidate prior to the candidate's application, the first attributed referral receives the bonus.

4.4 Bonus forfeiture

The bonus is forfeited if:

- The referrer leaves the Company before either payment milestone
- The candidate leaves the Company before the 90-day milestone (second installment only)
- The referral is found to have been made in violation of this policy or other Company policies

5. Diversity referral initiative

5.1. The Company periodically designates certain underrepresented-talent referrals for enhanced bonuses, typically a 50% uplift above the standard amount.

5.2. Enhanced bonuses are not automatic; the recruiting team identifies eligible referrals based on self-disclosed demographic information consistent with applicable law.

6. Conflicts of interest

6.1. Referrals of family members, household members, or close personal relations must be disclosed in the referral submission. Whether to advance such referrals is at the recruiting team's discretion in consultation with HR.

6.2. Referrals creating a potential reporting relationship (e.g., the referrer would become the candidate's direct manager) generally are not eligible for bonus, even if the hire proceeds.

7. Tax treatment

Referral bonuses are taxable income to the referrer and are reported through payroll consistent with applicable tax rules.

8. Privacy

Candidate information submitted via the ERP is handled consistent with the Candidate Privacy Notice and is not disclosed to other employees beyond the recruiting and hiring team for the role.

9. Restrictions

9.1. Referrers may not represent themselves to candidates as having authority over the hiring decision, salary, or other employment terms.

9.2. Pressuring candidates to apply, sharing confidential Company information with candidates pre-employment, or making representations beyond publicly available role information is prohibited.

9.3. Use of the ERP to refer candidates for the purpose of generating referral bonuses without a good-faith belief in candidate fit is prohibited and may result in disciplinary action.

10. Definitions

- **Referrer** — An eligible employee who submits a candidate via the ERP portal.
- **Active status** — Employed by the Company, not on a performance improvement plan that explicitly suspends eligibility for incentive programs.

- **Designated strategic role** — A role flagged by Talent Acquisition leadership as eligible for an enhanced bonus due to difficulty of fill or business priority.

11. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2022-02-15	J. Quan	Initial publication
1.2	2023-11-20	J. Quan	Added strategic role designation; updated bonus amounts
1.3	2025-01-01	J. Quan	Annual review

Next scheduled review: 2026-01-01 **Document owner:** Talent Acquisition

talent@northwindlogistics.com **Approver:** Chief People Officer **Related documents:** HR-104 Workplace Inclusion, CAND-PRIV-001 Candidate Privacy Notice